

minute, and the camera cuts to him walking out of a dressing room . . . in a movie-quality Batman costume.

The path to figuring out what you love to buy is lifelong. But it starts and continues with asking yourself a lot of questions, like if you could blow big money, not sock money, on one thing, what would it be? The tricky part is, most of the time, the things we actually want to buy aren't fine leather goods or superhero costumes. They're hard to pin down because they don't have concrete price tags.

Your Needs, My Needs

When we think about buying what we love, there are two categories: the tangible and the intangible. The tangible things are what people think of first: lattes, dinners, plane tickets. The intangible are the things we want but are harder to place a price tag on (even though there is a financial component to getting them): time with family and friends, health, and self-fulfillment. If we asked you what's more important, tangible or intangible things, you'd probably say the intangible. Most people do. So why is it that they're not the things we think of first when we consider what we spend "big money" on?

Maybe it's because we've been taught that "love don't cost a thing" and "the best things in life are free." If you've spent any time in this post-Covid world, you know those are both false. Personally, we think "I don't want no scrub" and "Cash rules everything around me" are more accurate mantras. Because the less money you have, the harder it is to pursue the intangibles you want.

Another reason might be that we've been taught that in order to look like we "have it together," we have to keep up with the purchases, trends, and home renovations of everyone else. The world is constantly telling us we need to buy things to express who we are. People judge how we're doing based on our appearance and how clean our home is on social media. (Pro tip: You only ever need to clean ten square feet of your home on a rotating basis to make everyone on social media think your whole home is spotless all the time!) When we desire the approval of others or want people to have a good perception of us, it's easier to gain this through our purchases than to explain the internal things that are fulfilling us. Buying things, wanting